

Linux really comes alive, so we've included a few of our favourite CLI tools for your use.

1. Youtube-dl

We've all downloaded YouTube videos at some point in time, but the process is fraught with complications. You usually enter the video URL into a website, which then asks you to download a Java plug-in (which has been shown to pose a security risk). A workaround to bypass this tedious process is the 'youtube-dl' command line tool, which downloads YouTube videos. You can specify the format (.flv, .mp4, .avi or .webm) and even the resolution of the video being downloaded. Though the name has 'YouTube' in it, you can use it to download files from a variety of services, including Vimeo, 8tracks and Dropbox (For a full list, visit <http://dgit.in/YTsites>). If you want to download a bunch of videos without having to re-enter the URL every time, simply enter all the links into a text file and pass the location of the file as an argument.

Tips for usage:

- ◆ To download a video in its default (.flv) format, use:


```
$ youtube-dl "<enter youtube URL here>"
```
- ◆ To view the different formats/resolutions available for download, use the following command:


```
$ youtube-dl -all-formats "<enter YouTube URL here>"
```

Find the documentation for the youtube-dl command line tool at <http://dgit.in/YTDocumentation>

2. Wget

Wget is a command that lets you download files from across a network using [HTTP/S](#) or [FTP](#), and optimises the download for slow or unreliable networks. If your download is interrupted due to intermittent network connectivity, Wget will automatically resume downloading from where it left off. Wget is typically found pre-installed on all Linux systems, being a part of the core utils package.

Tips for usage:

In its basic form, Wget takes one argument, i.e. the URL of the file.